

NetHope Connectivity+ Grant Application

NetHope Digital Programming & Connectivity+

NetHope's Digital Programming program is designed to bridge the new digital divides by supporting digitization across humanitarian crises and longer-term development needs. The program has three key pillars: closing the connectivity gap for people affected by crisis (what we refer to as "Connectivity+"), empowering local digital transformation, and building the foundation for AI-enabled programs.

The way that we look at connectivity has evolved. The past decade has seen billions of people become connected through mobile networks and the internet. This has created significant opportunities, but not all digital progress is driving human progress. Many crisis-affected areas still suffer from limited or no internet access, and those who are connected may not have meaningful or safe internet access. There are still significant gaps, particularly for women, people with disabilities, and minority language speakers. As one NetHope Member put it:

"This is less about 'the wires' and more about **connectivity as a means to shift power**. In the past, NetHope has done connectivity as a technology. This would be **connectivity as an equity issue** – enabling people to access information and protecting them while they are doing so."

"Connectivity+" builds on NetHope's existing work in emergency preparedness and response with an additional emphasis on building future resilience, in particular at the local level. It includes "the hardware" while also considering connectivity through the lens of equity, access, and power.

In addition to the existing emergency response offers for Members, including information sharing and coordination, flexible cash grants, in kind equipment donations, partner offers, and rapid response surge capacity, NetHope is pleased to offer a second round of the newly established grant targeted at Connectivity+ initiatives, in support of preparing for emergencies while building long-term resilience.

What is the Connectivity+ Grant?

The NetHope Connectivity+ Grant is a new initiative designed to strengthen the resilience of NetHope Member organizations through proactive funding. Its primary objective is to ensure Members are not only well prepared to respond to crises but also resilient to future disasters, with the right ICT equipment and training, coordination systems, and technical infrastructure in place, minimizing delays and overcoming operational challenges during emergency response.

Applicants will be encouraged to apply for funding of up to;
\$40,000 for Projects to be completed within 6 months of award

Members may apply for funding for any activity which will improve their/our sectoral emergency preparedness, response, and resilience practice. This might include:

- **Procurement of ICT connectivity equipment**, including routers, power supply units, and communication devices sourced from local or international vendors, to strengthen digital infrastructure in emergency settings.

- **Capacity building for local implementing partners and country offices**, strengthening localization objectives and building resilience among local first responders and affected communities through digital equipment and practices during emergencies.
- **Digital transformation of emergency operations**, including additional tools and training such as the procurement of mobile devices for data collection and coordination, monitoring and evaluation, and training for staff and local partners.
- **License fees, operational expenses or other costs** for technology tools, storage, partnerships, or subscriptions.
- **Recharge cost** for internal or partner staff.
- **Other costs** (e.g. travel).

Members may allocate a portion of funding to an implementing partner(s) or work together with local organizations. The funding, however, will be awarded directly to the Member, who will be responsible for redistribution, relevant compliance and reporting, and other costs.

Grant Application Process

- Applications will be accepted until 17:00 GMT Wednesday, May 27th, 2026.
- Evaluation will take place May 28th- June 4th, 2026.
- Award decisions will be announced Monday, June 8, 2026.

Eligibility Criteria

To be eligible for this funding:

- Applicants must be active NetHope Member or Associate organizations (current on dues).
 - NetHope Members/Associates may work together on a grant project, with NetHope Connected organizations, with non-NetHope organizations, and with other partners; however, one NetHope Member or Associate must act as the single lead applicant (Member Project Lead).
 - The Member Project Lead will be responsible for any redistribution of funds, relevant compliance and reporting, and other costs.
- Applicants must have an existing emergency response program and have responded to one or more emergencies in the past 24 months. This includes working with implementing partners in emergency response.

Evaluation Criteria

The selection process will be competitive and based on the following criteria:

- **Sustainability, Impact, & Resilience:** The grant should have long-term impact, with ongoing or lasting change sustained beyond the life of the grant, with a focus on how projects support resilience.
- **Localization & Equity:** Projects should, where possible, be designed to support local first responders, partners, staff and others based in the Global South.
- **Innovation & Transformation:** Preference will be given to projects showing innovative or transformative approaches to digitizing emergency response efforts.
- **Broader Ecosystem Benefit:** Projects should consider impact beyond the individual Member and at the broader ecosystem level.



These evaluation criteria will be used to score the applications. We are aware that these criteria will look different for smaller projects versus larger projects and will take this into account during evaluations.

We aim to select 2-3 applicants for award. We may provide additional grants depending on application budgets.

[See here projects funded under the NetHope Connectivity+ first round](#)

Project Reporting

Grant recipients will be expected to report on the progress of the project.

- **Final Report:** A written report detailing project outcomes and impact is required upon project completion, due 30 days after the end of the grant period. A report template will be provided by NetHope.
- **Progress Indicators:** Grant recipients will be expected to report on the reach of the grant measured by the Number of Organizations, People, Countries benefitting from the grant, Number of national geographical regions where the intervention has been implemented and Number of emergency responses supported by the grant. Grantees may also choose to report on additional optional indicators.
- **Knowledge dissemination:** We ask that Grantees share an artifact or output with the NetHope community. This may be, for example, a Summit session, Working Group or Chapter presentation, blog, or other materials showing lessons learned, inspiration, proven practices, etc.

How to apply

To apply, please fill out the [application form](#) on Microsoft Forms and upload:

- The [selected indicators form](#) to the [uploads folder](#) (also on page 2 of the application form).
- The [budget template](#) to the [uploads folder](#) (also on page 2 of the application form).

Deadline: 17:00 GMT Wednesday, May 27th, 2026.

Contact Details

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